

A wide-angle photograph of the Dubai skyline across the water. In the foreground, a small island with a domed building and a large flagpole flying the UAE flag is visible. The background is filled with numerous skyscrapers, including the Burj Khalifa. The sky is clear and blue. A blue graphic overlay with a binary code pattern is on the left side of the image.

2026

METHODOLOGY OF Key Transport Statistics

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1. Introduction

Key transport statistics provide a comprehensive and structured overview of transport infrastructure, operations, and activity within the Emirate of Abu Dhabi. They cover major transport sectors, including road, air, maritime, and postal services, capturing data on infrastructure, utilization, and performance.

These statistics are compiled to ensure the availability of consistent, reliable, and standardized information that supports monitoring and analysis of the transport sector over time.

In this context, the Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi (SCAD) is responsible for the compilation and dissemination of official transport statistics, based primarily on administrative data provided by relevant government entities, including the Department of Municipalities and Transport (DMT), Abu Dhabi Airports Company (ADAC), Abu Dhabi Ports, and Emirates Post.

2. Statistical Information

2.1. Importance and Objectives

Key Transport statistics are essential for understanding the development and performance of the transport sector in the Emirate of Abu Dhabi. They provide critical information on infrastructure, operations, and usage across different modes of transport, enabling the assessment of system efficiency, capacity, and demand.

These statistics form a key evidence base for planning, monitoring, and evaluating transport systems. Without accurate and timely transport data, it becomes challenging to design, implement, or assess policies related to infrastructure development, mobility, and logistics.

The specific objectives of transport statistics are:

- To provide reliable, high-quality indicators on transport infrastructure, operations, and usage in a timely and consistent manner
- To support evidence-based decision-making by supplying accurate data to policymakers, planners, and other stakeholders
- To enable effective planning, development, and evaluation of transport systems and infrastructure
- To monitor and analyse trends in mobility, connectivity, and transport demand across the Emirate
- To support the development of efficient, integrated, and sustainable transport systems aligned with the Emirate's strategic objectives

2.2. Key Outputs

The main output of key transport statistics in the Emirate of Abu Dhabi consist of a set of key indicators across different transport domains, including:

1. **Transportation:** This includes indicators related to public transport operations, usage, and regulatory activities within the Emirate. It reflects service provision, demand levels, and compliance within the transport system.
2. **Aircraft Movement:** This includes indicators related aircraft activity at airports, providing insights into the frequency and distribution of air traffic over time.

3. **Post:** This includes indicators related to postal infrastructure and mail operations, reflecting service availability and postal activity.
4. **Passengers:** This includes indicators related to passenger movement through air transport, providing insights into travel patterns and demand.
5. **Cargo:** This includes indicators related to the movement of goods across air and maritime transport, supporting the analysis of logistics and trade flows.
6. **Ships Turnaround:** This includes indicators related to vessel activity and operational efficiency at ports.
7. **Road Network:** This includes indicators related to road infrastructure and its characteristics, supporting the assessment of network capacity and quality.

2.3. Concepts and Definitions

The concepts and definitions used are those approved by the Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi, aligned with internationally recognized terminology. These include the following:

- **Road Transport:** Transport activities conducted through road infrastructure, including public transport, taxis, registered vehicles, road networks, and related transport operations
- **Air Transport:** Transport activities related to aircraft movement, passenger movement, air cargo, and freight operations through airports.
- **Maritime Transport:** Transport activities related to vessels, ports, cargo movement, containers, and maritime operations.
- **Postal Services:** Activities related to postal infrastructure and services, including mail movement, parcels, post offices, and mailboxes.

2.4. Classifications and standards applied

The Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi (SCAD) adheres to internationally recognized standards in the compilation of transport statistics, in accordance with approved definitions and classifications. The following international frameworks and guidelines are applied, where applicable:

- Glossary for Transport Statistics (UNECE, Eurostat, ITF)
- System of National Accounts (SNA 2008)
- International Standard Industrial Classification of All Economic Activities (ISIC Rev.4)
- SDG Indicator Metadata (United Nations)
- International Recommendations for Tourism Statistics (IRTS 2008)

At the national level, SCAD applies the Statistical Data Quality Framework for Abu Dhabi and adopts classifications and standards used by relevant administrative entities to ensure consistency across data sources.

2.5. Available Breakdown

The Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi publishes a wide range of transport indicators. These are disseminated according to the following breakdowns:

Geographical breakdown:

- Abu Dhabi Region
- Al Ain Region
- Al Dhafra Region

Time breakdown:

- Annual
- Monthly (January to December), where applicable

Transport mode and location:

- By airport (e.g., Zayed International Airport, Al Ain International Airport)
- By port
- By transport service type (e.g., local, regional, inter-city)

Type of movement:

- Arrivals / Departures / Transit
- Loaded / Discharged
- Internal / External (incoming and outgoing)

Passenger and cargo characteristics:

- By region of embarkation and disembarkation
- By world regions

Postal classification:

- By type of mail (e.g., registered letters, parcels, express mail)
- By type of movement (internal, external incoming, external outgoing)

Road and transport characteristics:

- By road classification
- By vehicle type
- By type of transport service

2.6. Statistical Population

Transport statistics include all transport-related units and activities within the Emirate of Abu Dhabi. This covers infrastructure (such as roads, ports, airports, and postal facilities), transport means (vehicles, ships, and aircraft), and transport operations (passenger movement, cargo, and postal services) occurring across the three geographical regions of the Emirate.

2.7. Statistical Unit

The statistical unit refers to the basic entity for which data is collected and compiled. In transport statistics, the statistical unit varies depending on the indicator and may include:

- Individual passengers
- Vehicles (e.g., cars, buses, taxis)
- Aircraft
- Ships
- Shipments (cargo containers, mail items)
- Infrastructure units (e.g., roads, airports, ports, post offices)
-

2.8. Geographic Coverage

Geographical coverage includes the three regions in the Emirate of Abu Dhabi: Abu Dhabi, Al Ain, and Al Dhafra.

2.9. Unit of Measure

The Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi publishes transport indicators using standardized measurement units, depending on the nature of each indicator. These include:

Counts and totals:

- Number
- People
- Night

Monetary values:

- Emirati Dirham (AED)
- Million Emirati Dirham

Weights and quantities:

- Ton
- Metric Ton

Distance and length:

- Kilometer (km)

Time:

- Hour

Rates and ratios:

- Percentage (%)
- Traffic accidents per 1,000 population
- Deaths and injuries per 1,000 population
- Traffic accidents per 1,000 vehicles
- Visitors per 1,000 population

Index / qualitative scale:

- Result (scale from 1 to 4)

2.10. Reference Period

The reference period for transport statistics varies by indicator. Data are compiled based on different reference periods, including the previous calendar year, calendar month, quarter, or six-month period, depending on the nature and frequency of the indicator.

2.11. Timeliness

The Statistics Center - Abu Dhabi - publishes key transport statistics within 12 months after the reference period.

2.12. Frequency of Dissemination

Key transport statistics are disseminated on a regular basis, with most indicators released annually and selected indicators published on a quarterly basis.

2.13. Data Time Series

The length of the available time series for transport statistics varies by indicator. Data for different indicators is available from different starting years, beginning as early as 2008 and extending to recent years up to 2026.

This variation in the starting year of coverage reflects differences in the timing of data availability, data collection practices, and the inclusion of each indicator within the statistical production system.

2.14. Abu Dhabi Special Considerations

It should be noted that Abu Dhabi is an emirate and one of 7 emirates in UAE, and data collected is limited to Abu Dhabi emirate territorial. However, since the administrative sources used for collating data pertinent to key transport statistics also operate at the emirate level, this should not be a factor which compromises data quality.

3. Statistical Processing

3.1. Data Source

Key transport statistics are primarily based on administrative data collected from the Department of Municipalities and Transport (DMT), Abu Dhabi Airports Company (ADAC), Abu Dhabi Ports Group, and Emirates Post. Additional supporting data are obtained, where relevant, from other government entities and administrative records. Some indicators are calculated by the Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi.

3.1.1. Survey Data

Key transport statistics are primarily based on administrative data and are not generally produced from survey data. However, selected indicators may incorporate data from surveys, such as the Annual Economic Survey and e-commerce surveys, where relevant to transport and logistics activities.

3.1.2. Administrative Data

Key transport statistics are based on administrative data collected from the Department of Municipalities and Transport (DMT), Abu Dhabi Airports Company (ADAC), Abu Dhabi Ports Group, and Emirates Post. Some indicators are calculated by the Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi.

3.2. Data Validation and Editing

3.2.1. Data Validation

The validation and editing process of raw data is important as it constitutes the basis for subsequent statistical analysis. SCAD implements various measures to ensure data accuracy and high-quality standards. All required data is verified for completeness and compliance with the Centre's requirements. Administrative data is regularly audited to detect, address, and properly document any errors. Data consistency with statistical definitions and classifications is verified, outliers are reviewed, and the logical coherence of the data is checked.

Key transport data are reviewed and edited in relation to previous years and the data associated therewith, checking logicity by considering both internal (relationships, structure and correlations within the dataset) and external consistency (data supplied in previous years and other data associated therewith).

In some cases, automated rules embedded in electronic data capturing platforms are also used to detect errors or determine unacceptable responses/entries. Reports on the errors are then submitted to the relevant parties.

SCAD may also implement or require government entities to implement the following types of data editing in specific cases, as is also outlined in the Statistical Data Editing Guide:

- **Validity and completeness of data:** The validity of the data refers to the correctness of the responses/entries, based on the possible options (number, percentage, etc.).
- **Range:** The range sets the minimum and maximum expected values of the variable.
- **Duplicate data entry:** Verifying that the data of each unit of the register or the database was entered only once, with no duplication, especially when there are variations in some index fields of the unit within the record.
- **Logical consistency:** Consistency is the presence of logical relationships and interdependence between the variables. This type of editing considers the connection between data fields or variables.
- **Outliers:** This type of editing follows other checks and is used for the detection of extreme values, based on the distribution of the current data and previous data series, which makes it easier to detect the values that can be considered unusual or extreme, so that they can be checked and verified.

3.2.2. Missing Data Adjustments

The Statistical Data Quality Framework for Abu Dhabi outlines the quality standards which SCAD is committed to achieve, whether the source of such data is statistical surveys or administrative records. The framework seeks to create a unified understanding of statistical quality for all entities in the Statistical System in the Emirate of Abu Dhabi (SSAD), which will enable these entities to prepare consistent mechanisms and procedures in order to monitor, evaluate and develop the statistical quality of its administrative and survey data.

Furthermore, the Manual of Statistical Quality Standards and Procedures for Administrative Records presents key standards and procedures to ensure the statistical quality of administrative records data. The manual, which is consistent with adopted international and local standards, outlines and describes the following quality dimensions: 1) organizational structure; 2) relevance; 3) clarity of administrative records preparation methodology; 4) accuracy; 5) coherence and consistency; 6) accessibility; and 7) timeliness, periodicity and punctuality.

3.3. Statistical Calculation Method

Transport statistics are primarily derived using basic statistical aggregation and ratio-based calculations applied to administrative data. Most indicators are compiled through summation of reported values (e.g., total number of passengers, vehicles, vessels, or cargo), while others are calculated using standard ratios and rates to support analysis and comparability.

Key calculation approaches include:

- **Totals and aggregates:** Summation of counts across entities, locations, or time periods (e.g., total passengers, cargo, vessels, or postal items)

- Ratios and rates: Indicators such as vehicles per kilometer, vehicles per 1,000 population, and accident rates per population or vehicles
- Averages: Calculation of averages such as fuel prices or operational performance indicators (e.g., turnaround time)
- Derived indicators: Combination of multiple variables (e.g., total cargo = loaded + discharged)

These calculations are applied consistently across indicators and may be further disaggregated by dimensions such as region, time period, type of movement, or transport mode.

3.4. Seasonal Adjustment

Seasonally adjusted estimates are not produced for this publication.

4. Methodology Changes

Methodological changes in relation to administrative data may occur in line with changes in quality assurance and editing processes, organizational structures and systems in place. The methodology may also be amended bearing in mind factors such as policy objectives and indicator relevance. There have, however, been no recent methodology changes related to key transport statistics.

5. Revision Policy

Continuous data refinement is mandated to ensure the accuracy of data and statistical products provided by the Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi. This involves revising official statistics published through printed documents or approved dissemination channels. The policy outlines general rules for reviewing and publishing statistics, informing users of potential review reasons, categorizing refinements, and documenting all review aspects. This framework allows producers to determine review mechanisms based on specific characteristics. The refinement policy covers all indicators, statistics, and time series of varying periodicities. Additionally, the Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi publishes a general data refinement policy applicable to all statistics under its responsibility, ensuring adaptability to the distinct characteristics of various statistics and allowing for specialized refinement policies in alignment with the general policy.

6. Statistical Quality

The quality of statistical data focuses on the concept of (data relevance for use) by preparing statistical data characterized by a set of traits and properties that meet and align with the data requirements of users and decision-makers. Thus, statistical quality exists within an institutional environment that is characterized by professionalism, integrity, and neutrality, closely related to the set objectives for the data and the needs of users. This is achieved through the use of a clear, standardized framework that ensures the data's reliability, realism, comparability, efficiency, accessibility, and flexibility, and that it is available to all within an appropriate timeframe and in an easily accessible and usable manner.

Statistical product quality reports are prepared by the Quality Team in SCAD.

7. Appendix Table

S.V. Code	Indicator Name	اسم المؤشر
1398	Quantity of Airmail from Zayed International Airport by Type of Movement - Annually	كمية البريد الجوي من مطار زايد الدولي حسب نوع الحركة - سنوي
1406	Number of Public Mailboxes - Annually	عدد صناديق البريد العامة - سنوي
1407	Number of Private Mailboxes - Annually	عدد صناديق البريد الخاصة - سنوي
1408	Mails and postal parcels movement by type and type of movement - Annually	حركة الرسائل والطرود البريدية حسب النوع ونوع الحركة - سنوي
1409	Number of post offices - Annually	عدد مكاتب البريد - سنوي
1412	Number of Vehicles in Abu Dhabi Ports by Type of Movement - Annually	عدد المركبات في موانئ أبوظبي حسب نوع الحركة - سنوي
1413	General cargo at Abu Dhabi Ports by Type of Movement - Annually	كمية البضائع العامة في موانئ أبوظبي حسب نوع الحركة - سنوي
1418	Number of Containers at Abu Dhabi Ports by Type of Movement - Annually	عدد الحاويات في موانئ أبوظبي حسب نوع الحركة - سنوي
1540	Number of Containers at Abu Dhabi Ports by Type of Movement and World Regions - Annually	عدد الحاويات في موانئ أبوظبي حسب نوع الحركة ومناطق العالم - سنوي
1414	Total gross tonnage at Abu Dhabi Commercial Ports by Port - Annually	إجمالي الحمولة الكلية في موانئ أبوظبي التجارية حسب الميناء - سنوي
1403	Quantity of Air Cargo by Type of Movement and Airport - Annually	كمية الشحن الجوي حسب نوع الحركة والمطار - سنوي
1404	Quantity of Outbound Air Cargo from Zayed International Airport by Region of Disembarkation - Annually	كمية الشحن الجوي الصادر من مطار زايد الدولي حسب منطقة الوجهة - سنوي
1405	Quantity of inbound Air Cargo to Zayed International Airport by Region of Embarkation - Annually	كمية الشحن الجوي الوارد لمطار زايد الدولي حسب منطقة الانطلاق - سنوي
1399	Air passengers by airport - Annually	المسافرون جواً حسب المطار - سنوي
1400	Air passengers by type of movement and airport - Annually	المسافرون جواً حسب نوع الحركة والمطار - سنوي
1401	Arrivals at Zayed International Airport by Region of Embarkation - Annually	القادمون عبر مطار زايد الدولي حسب منطقة الانطلاق - سنوي
1402	Departures at Zayed International Airport by Region of Disembarkation - Annually	المغادرون عبر مطار زايد الدولي حسب منطقة الوجهة - سنوي
1393	Number of public transport buses by region - Annually	عدد حافلات النقل العام حسب المنطقة - سنوي

1394	Number of public transport bus passengers by region and type of transport service - Annually	عدد ركاب حافلات النقل العام حسب المنطقة وخدمة النقل - سنوي
1395	Number of public transport bus passengers - Annually	عدد ركاب حافلات النقل العام - سنوي
4786	Number of public transport bus trips - Annually	عدد رحلات حافلات النقل العام - سنوي
4796	Travel distances of public transport buses - Annually	المسافة المقطوعة لحافلات النقل العام - سنوي
5156	Number of taxis - Annually	عدد سيارات الأجرة - سنوي
4793	Number of hybrid/electric taxis - Annually	عدد سيارات الأجرة الهجينة/الكهربائية - سنوي
4785	Number of taxi passengers - Annually	عدد ركاب سيارات الأجرة - سنوي
4784	Number of taxi trips - Annually	عدد رحلات سيارات الأجرة - سنوي
4795	Travel distances of taxis - Annually	المسافة المقطوعة لسيارات الأجرة - سنوي
4792	Number of Integrated Transport Center fines for taxis - Annually	عدد مخالفات مركز النقل المتكامل لسيارات الأجرة - سنوي
4791	Number of Integrated Transport Center fines for public transport bus users - Annually	عدد مخالفات مركز النقل المتكامل لمستخدمي حافلات النقل العام - سنوي
4790	Number of Integrated Transport Center fines for public transport buses - Annually	عدد مخالفات مركز النقل المتكامل لحافلات النقل العام - سنوي
4789	Number of Integrated Transport Center fines for school buses - Annually	عدد مخالفات مركز النقل المتكامل لحافلات المدارس - سنوي
4787	Number of Darb fines - Annually	عدد مخالفات درب - سنوي
4788	Number of Mawaqif fines - Annually	عدد مخالفات مواقف - سنوي
1396	Aircraft movement by airport - Annually	حركة الطائرات حسب المطار - سنوي
1397	Aircraft movement by airport and month - Annually	حركة الطائرات حسب المطار والشهر - سنوي
1410	Number of Ships at Abu Dhabi Ports - Annually	عدد السفن في موانئ أبوظبي - سنوي
1411	Number of Ships at Abu Dhabi Ports by Port - Annually	عدد السفن في موانئ أبوظبي حسب الميناء - سنوي
1417	Total Ships Stay at Abu Dhabi Commercial Ports by Port - Annually	إجمالي مدة توقف السفن في موانئ أبوظبي التجارية حسب الميناء - سنوي
1390	Total length of external roads by region - Annually	إجمالي أطوال الطرق الخارجية حسب المنطقة - سنوي
1391	Length of external roads by classification and region - Annually	أطوال الطرق الخارجية حسب التصنيف والمنطقة - سنوي
1392	Total length of internal roads by region - Annually	إجمالي أطوال الطرق الداخلية حسب المنطقة - سنوي
4677	Quality of road network - Annually	جودة شبكة الطرق - سنوي

8655	Number of Public Electric Vehicle Chargers by Region and District - Annually	عدد شواحن المركبات الكهربائية العامة حسب المنطقة والمنطقة الفرعية - سنوي
8647	Number of Vehicles by Year of Manufacture - Quarterly	عدد المركبات حسب سنة الصنع - ربع سنوي
8624	Number of Vehicles by Year of Manufacture - Annually	عدد المركبات حسب سنة الصنع - سنوي
8649	Number of Registered Vehicles and Machinery by Type and Region - Quarterly	عدد المركبات والآليات المرخصة حسب النوع والمنطقة - ربع سنوي
8803	Number of Public Transport Bus Stations - Annually	عدد محطات حافلات النقل العام - سنوي
8656	Number of Public Transport Bus Stations by Region - Annually	عدد محطات حافلات النقل العام حسب المنطقة - سنوي
8625	Number of Public Transport Bus Stations by District - Annually	عدد محطات حافلات النقل العام حسب المنطقة الفرعية - سنوي
8648	Number of Vehicle Licensing Transactions by Type of Transaction - Quarterly	عدد معاملات ترخيص المركبات حسب نوع المعاملة - ربع سنوي

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